Egypt University of Informatics

Computer and Information Systems

Data Analysis Course

The Analysis of Consumer Preferences Between Local and International Clothing Brands

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04/08/2026

Introduction

Clothing choices are an essential part of daily life and reflect **consumer priorities** such as **price, quality, and brand perception.** With the increasing availability of both local and international clothing brands, **consumers are often faced with multiple options when making purchasing decisions.**

This study aims to **explore consumer preferences between local and international clothing brands** and identify the key factors influencing these decisions. Understanding these preferences can provide valuable insights into consumer behaviour and market trends.

Research Question

Do consumers prefer local or international clothing brands, and what factors influence their purchasing decisions?

Hypothesis

Consumers are **more likely to prefer local clothing brands** due to their affordability, better value for money, and increasing improvements in quality. Additionally, factors such as supporting local businesses and better fit contribute to a stronger preference for local brands among consumers

Population of Interest:

The population of interest for this study consists of **young consumers**, **university students and young adults aged between 18 and 24** who actively purchase clothing. This group was selected because they are highly engaged in fashion trends, frequently make purchasing decisions, and are more likely to be influenced by factors such as price, quality, and brand perception. Therefore, they provide relevant insights into preferences between local and international clothing brands.

Sampling Method:

A convenience sampling method was used by **distributing the survey among university students through student groups and personal networks (friends and classmates)**. This approach was chosen because it allows easy and fast access to participants who belong to the target group of the study.

Although this method may limit the generalizability of the results, it is appropriate for this research as it provides relevant insights into the preferences of young consumers within a real and accessible environment.

Bias Identification:

In designing this survey, several potential sources of bias were identified and considered. One of the main limitations is **sampling bias**, as the survey was distributed among university students and personal networks (friends and classmates), which may result in a sample that does not fully represent the broader population.

Another potential bias is **response bias**, as participants may answer based on personal opinions, experiences, or brand perceptions rather than objective evaluation. Additionally, **social influence bias** may occur, since participants from similar environments may share similar preferences and attitudes.

To minimize these biases, the survey questions were carefully designed to be clear, simple, and neutral, avoiding any leading or suggestive wording. All answer options were presented equally to ensure fairness, and the survey was conducted anonymously to encourage honest and unbiased responses.

Survey Questions:

1. What is your age group?
2. What is your gender?
3. How often do you buy clothing?
4. Where do you usually shop for clothing?
5. How do you usually shop?
6. What is the most important factor when choosing clothing?
7. Compared to international brands, how are local brands priced?
8. How would you rate the quality of local brands?
9. Do you think international brands are worth their price?
10. If two similar items are available, which would you choose?
11. What would make you choose a local brand over an international one?
12. What would make you choose an international brand over a local one?

Online survey link: Here

number of samples collected: 50

Analysis:

1. Shopping Frequency Analysis:

For the shopping frequency variable, the **mean value of 2.66** and **median of 3** indicate that most participants purchase clothing on a moderately regular basis, such as **every season or every few months**.

The **mode value of 2** further confirms that **purchasing clothing every season is the most common behaviour among respondents**.

How often do you buy clothing?

Monthly ----> 4

Every 3 months ----> 3

Every season ----> 2

Rarely ----> 1

2. Brand Preference Analysis:

Regarding brand preference, the **mean value of 1.86** suggests that **some** participants **prefer international brands**.

The median value of 1.5 indicates that **responses are distributed between local and international brands**.

Finally, **the mode value is 1**, which represents local brands. **This means that the most frequent choice among respondents is local brands**.

Where do you usually shop for clothing?

Local brands ----> 1

International brands ----> 2

Both equally ----> 3

3. Shopping Method Analysis:

For shopping method, **the mode value of 3** indicates that most participants prefer a combination of both online and in-store shopping.

The mean value of 2.36 supports this finding, suggesting that consumers value both convenience and physical interaction when making purchasing decisions.

The median value is 2.0, which shows that at least half of the participants lean toward in-store shopping.

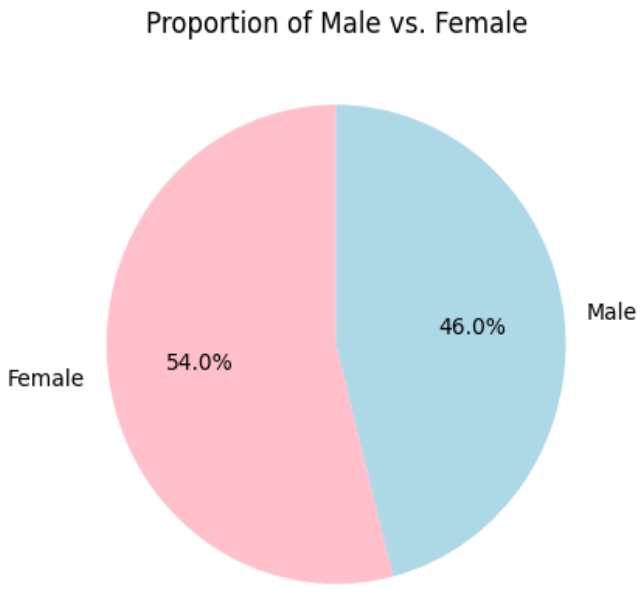
This indicates that while many prefer a mix of both methods, traditional in-store shopping still plays an important role for a significant portion of respondents.

How do you usually shop?

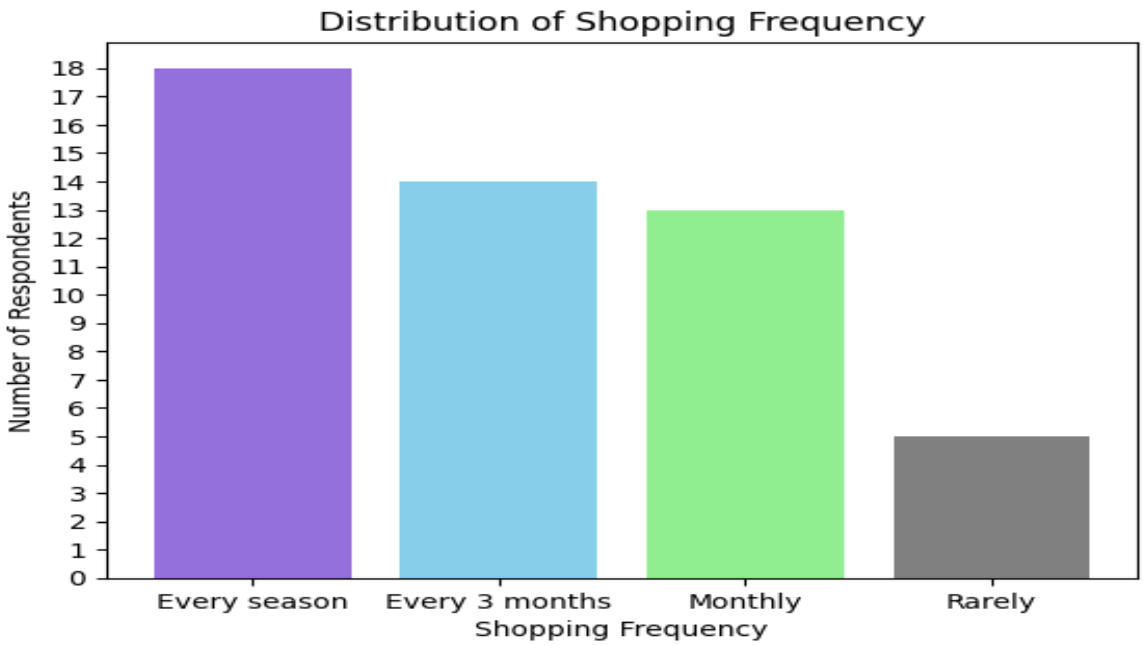
Online ----> 1

In-store ----> 2

Both ----> 3

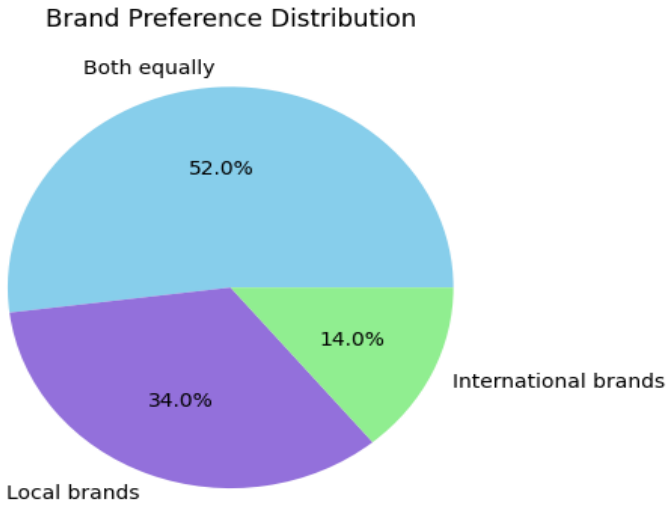


The chart shows the distribution of participants by gender, with a relatively balanced representation of males and females. This balance helps ensure that the results are not biased toward a specific gender group.

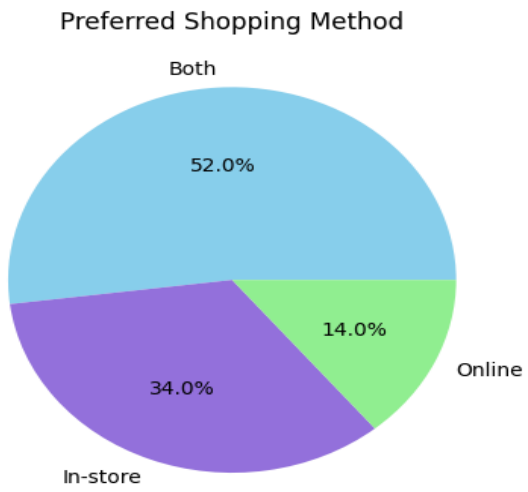


The chart shows the distribution of shopping frequency among participants, with most respondents purchasing clothing either monthly or every season.

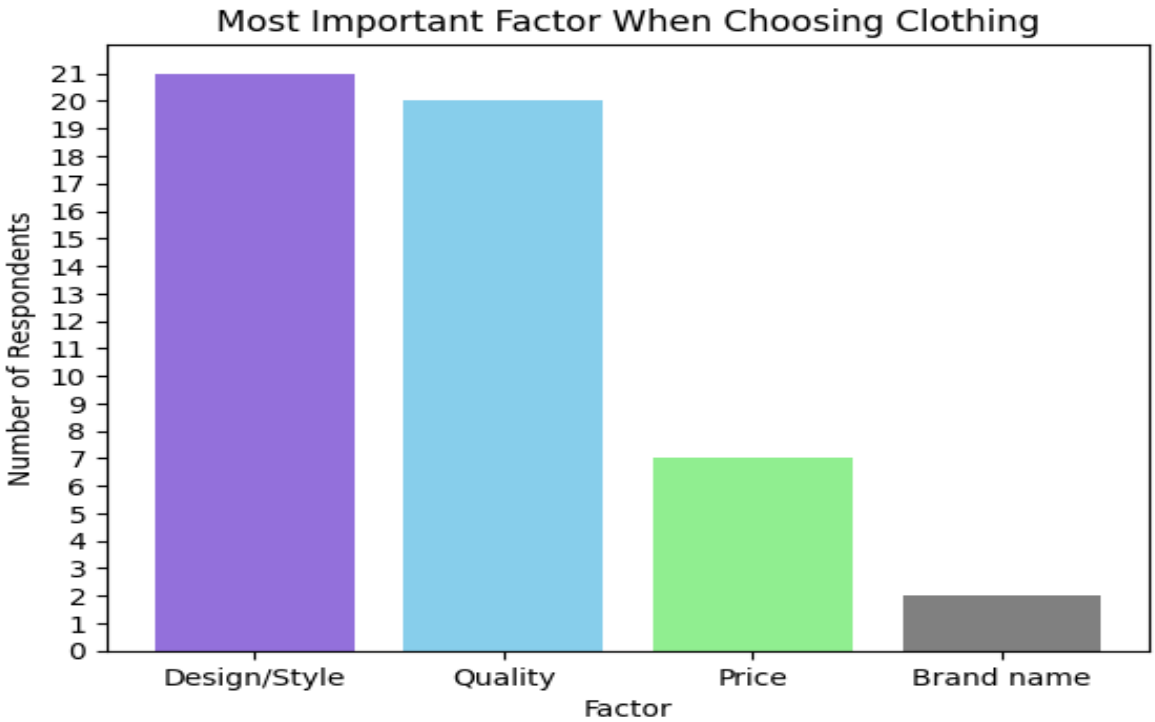
This indicates that clothing shopping is a regular habit for many consumers rather than a rare activity.



The chart shows the distribution of brand preferences among participants, with a large proportion favoring international brands or both local and international options.
This indicates that while international brands are popular, local brands still play an important role in consumer choices.
The high percentage of participants choosing both equally suggests that consumers do not rely on a single type of brand and tend to balance between local and international options.

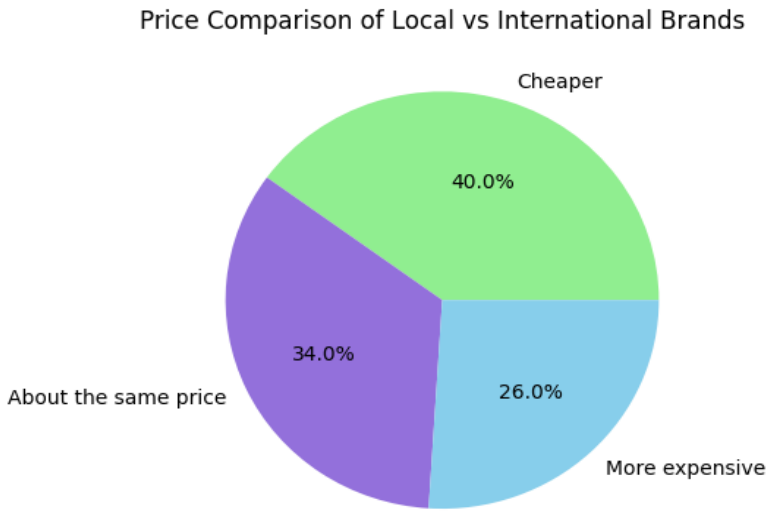


The chart shows that a large proportion of participants prefer a combination of online and in-store shopping methods. This indicates that consumers value both convenience and the ability to physically inspect products before purchasing.

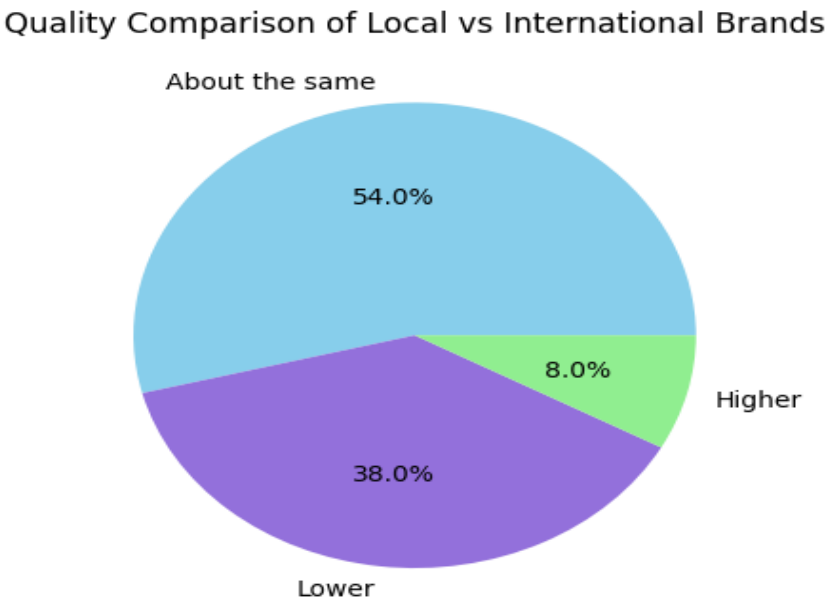


The chart shows that price and quality are the most important factors influencing consumer decisions. This indicates that consumers prioritize value for money over brand name when choosing clothing.

A high preference for design suggests that style and appearance play a significant role in purchasing decisions

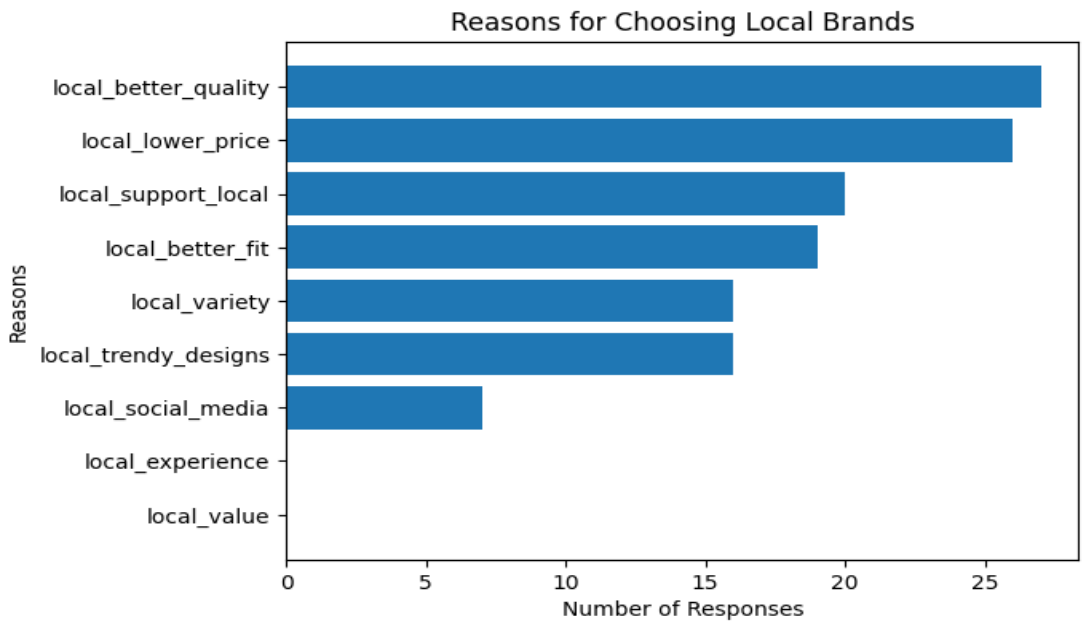


The chart shows that a large proportion of participants perceive local brands as cheaper compared to international brands. This indicates that affordability is a key factor that makes local brands more attractive to consumers.

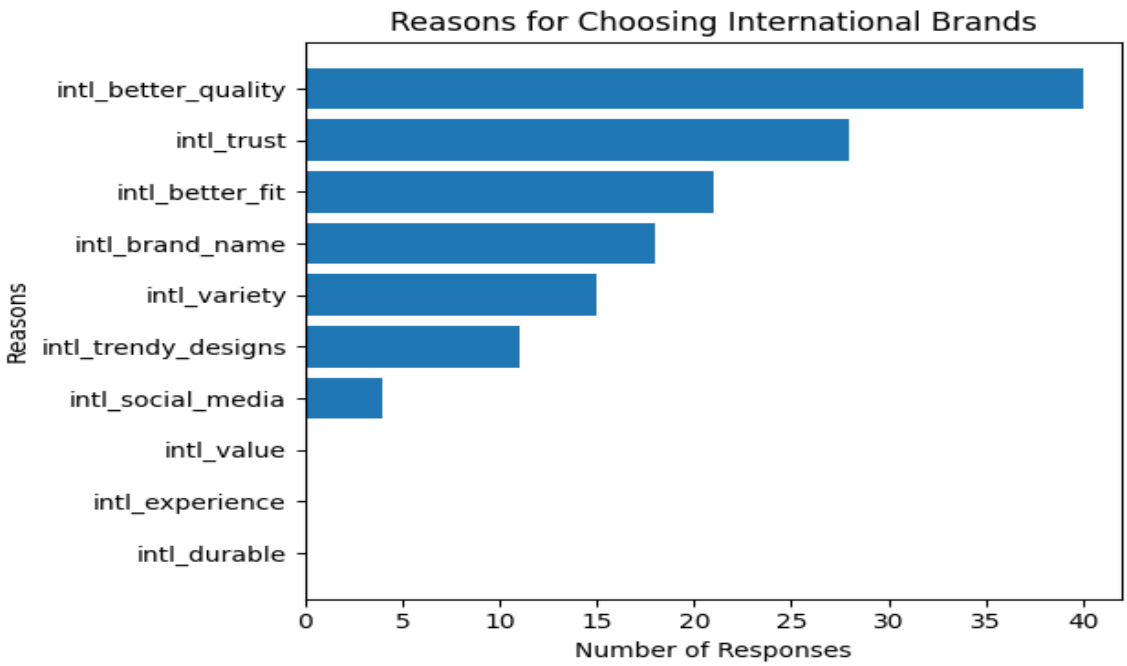


The chart shows that many participants perceive the quality of local brands as either lower or similar to international brands. This suggests that quality perception remains a challenge for local brands when competing with international ones.

The chart shows that participants are evenly divided in their opinions on whether international brands are worth their price. This indicates that consumers have mixed perceptions, with no clear consensus regarding the value of international brands



The chart shows that better quality and lower price are the most important reasons for choosing local brands among participants. This indicates that consumers are primarily driven by value for money when selecting local products. Additionally, supporting local businesses and better fit also play a significant role in influencing their choices.



The chart shows that better quality and trust are the most important reasons for choosing international brands among participants. This indicates that consumers associate international brands with higher reliability and superior performance. Additionally, factors such as better fit and brand name also contribute to their preference.

Conclusion

The findings of this study suggest that neither local nor international brands clearly dominate consumer preferences. Instead, the results indicate a balanced competition between the two.

International brands appear to have a stronger advantage in terms of perceived quality and brand trust, which makes them attractive to many consumers. However, local brands remain highly competitive due to their lower prices and better value for money.

Therefore, while international brands may have a slight advantage in overall perception, local brands play an equally important role in consumer decision-making, especially when affordability is considered.

Overall, the results show that consumers tend to balance quality and price rather than strongly favoring one type of brand over the other.

Any potential issues

1. Convenience sampling was used, as the survey was distributed among university students and personal networks (friends and classmates), which may limit sample diversity and affect the generalizability of the results.

2. The sample size is relatively small (50 responses), which is sufficient for basic analysis but may not capture all consumer perspectives. Most participants belong to a similar age group, which may create a bias toward younger consumers' preferences.

3. There is a potential hidden bias due to subjective perceptions, as questions about price and quality depend on personal opinions rather than objective measures.

4. The survey relies on self-reported data, which may introduce response bias or inaccuracies in participants' answers. Despite these limitations, the data still provides useful insights into general consumer trends within the selected group.